

4.3.2 Texts

The following conditions apply to the texts chosen:

- one text must have been written pre-1900
- two different authors must be studied
- set texts listed for the A-level exam components cannot be used for non-exam assessment, even if they will not be used in the exam
- the essay is comparative and connective so equal attention must be paid to both texts
- a poetry text could be either one longer narrative poem or a single authored collection of shorter poems. If using a collection of poetry, students must have studied the whole text and select at least two poems to write about in detail as examples of the wider collection

- single authored collections of short stories are permissible. If using a collection of short stories, students must have studied the whole text and select at least two stories to write about in detail as examples of the wider collection
- texts chosen for study may include texts in translation that have been influential and significant in the development of literature in English. The translated text should be treated as the original writer's own words for assessment purposes. Therefore, schools and colleges should ensure that they use a version recognised by academia as being a high quality translation which supports the original author's writing appropriately.

Recommended texts

Texts listed in the A-level core set text and comparative set text lists in Sections 4.1 and 4.2 cannot be studied for non-exam assessment. Texts chosen for study may include texts in translation that have been influential and significant in the development of literature in English.

Possible pre-1900 texts include, but are not limited to:

Prose

Author	Text
Jane Austen	<i>Northanger Abbey</i>
	<i>Mansfield Park</i>
Anne Brontë	<i>The Tenant of Wildfell Hall</i>
Wilkie Collins	<i>The Moonstone</i>
	<i>The Woman in White</i>
Charles Dickens	<i>Hard Times</i>
George Eliot	<i>Middlemarch</i>
	<i>The Mill on the Floss</i>
Elizabeth Gaskell	<i>North and South</i>
Mary Shelley	<i>Frankenstein</i>
William Makepeace Thackeray	<i>Vanity Fair</i>
Oscar Wilde	<i>The Picture of Dorian Gray</i>

Drama

Author	Text
William Congreve	<i>The Way of the World</i>
Henrik Ibsen	<i>A Doll's House</i>
	<i>Hedda Gabler</i>
Oliver Goldsmith	<i>She Stoops to Conquer</i>
George Bernard Shaw	any pre-1900 play by this writer
Richard Brinsley Sheridan	<i>The School for Scandal</i>
Oscar Wilde	any pre-1900 play by this writer
William Wycherley	<i>The Country Wife</i>

Poetry

Author	Text
Geoffrey Chaucer	'The Wife of Bath's Tale'
	'The Miller's Tale'
Samuel Taylor Coleridge	'The Rime of the Ancient Mariner'
John Keats	'Lamia'
	'Isabella or The Pot of Basil'
	'The Eve of St Agnes'